

2020

HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE TRIAL EXAMINATION

English Advanced

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

Stimulus Booklet

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This paper **MUST NOT** be removed from the examination room

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Section I

Text 1 — Prose non-fiction

Winter in the Illawarra*

First, before the season, before all seasons, you should know this is Dharawal country. In our talking about the cold (*dagura*) and the cool change (*murayung*) and the cold wind (*buruwi*) we should roll the words in our mouths. Because what can be said about a season that hasn't already been written in English? There is nothing new under the sun or moon or stars or cold-rain-filled-clouds rolling in from the Alpine. Perhaps I could show you and not tell?

You could take the coast road here or arrive from over the hinterland. You could descend into the slice of coast, past all the fern and forest. When you arrive at sea level and, if no one is here is welcome to you in person, you can thank the high and low ground and the fresh and salt water yourself. You could travel light years, watch the canoes gliding over the surface of the water. Nature is on time in the eruption and retreat of flowers, foliage, tides and fish foraging in coves.

You can visit Nana's house – she'll have a hot plate for you. You can sit in Poppy's place in the sunroom with the telly on. Footy season: whether you scrum or scramble, there's a game to watch. You can put your feet up in woolly socks, have a hot chocolate. Take your time. And if you look beyond the telly, out the window, you'll see the *grevillea* still in bloom and the honey-eaters, lorikeets and wattle birds arriving to drink from the stem, all season, all year long. And then wander out to Lake Illawarra, enter the canoe and you can catch a few brim and luderick fish. Through the mouth of the estuary you could catch a break too, make sure the wetsuit reaches your wrists and ankles. The Pacific is deep and cold and blue.

Grieve all the days you didn't embrace the sun last season. All the days it was too difficult to face the light. It isn't winter that is coming but the pause before spring, that interval between shows, the chance to ready yourself against the world.

I am always at home and I am never there, never here. I'm always at the altar of the beach, high in the dunes under a hoodie, single serve of paper-wrapped hot chips, watching the grey water drop away into the abyss.

TARA JUNE WINCH

* The Illawarra is a coastal region situated immediately south of Sydney

Text 2 — Poem

Strange

For the very young everything is strange
Even before they can pronounce the word
(Or spell it); comforts and terrors come,
And puzzlement is always within range:
The carolling of some early-morning bird,
The noises that tap (or beat) upon the drum
Of consciousness, the growing dawn and dark,
The rain, the human voices near and far, the stark
Hungers and thirsts – what can they mean
When mornings shuffle past in blurred
Succession, or crowd around with murmuring voices?
Who can explain the sun, the stars, the moon,
Or time, that ever-mysterious medium
Through which the world of phenomena appear and disappear?

And yet even the not-so-young
May be forgiven if, at times, it seems
Worlds within worlds (present, future, past)
Collide as they do in dreams ...
In the supermarkets of the universe
We roller-skate at speeds too fast
To assess the value of anything except the price
Of roller skates (or at least, the last
Price when we bought the present wobbly pair).
In the expanding aisles we hurtle through,
Let's take time out from visiting the nearest zoo –
Is anything more 'strange' than *me* – and *you*?

BRUCE DAWE

Text 3 — Feature article

Letters from My Grandfather

On an Anzac Day we're all forced to be apart, I've stumbled across a portal of connection and remembrance. In between working from home, schooling from home and cleaning my home, I've been journeying through centuries and hemispheres. Self-isolation has changed the way we see things. In my case, the restrictions saw me eyeing off the innocuous-looking green ring binder on my bookshelf. As the meme goes, "Our grandparents had to go to war, you just have to sit on the couch". I'd been sitting on the couch. I wondered what it felt like to go to war.

June 24, 1918: Dear Prairie Lady - Want to go to the station with me yesterday? Come on. The train is on the North Spur so we'll have to hurry to get there on time ... Then we pull out. Women are there in droves to cling hands, through windows and weep. Mrs Savage smiled, always will I remember it — and said, 'Well Leon, give 'em hell!' and all the while she was crying inside — I know it.

In 1918 my great-grandfather was serving in the dog days of World War I. He was 21, passionately in love and — oh boy — could he write. For 12 months James ('Jim') sent letters of love, pain and all that fell in between, to his sweetheart Katherine ('Kay'). My grandma, Jim's daughter, painstakingly transcribed the originals and gifted them to me on my 24th birthday.

We all have so much time at the moment. So I'm taking this project slowly. Each night I approach the next letter. I try not to read ahead (although, some would say, my very existence is the ultimate plot spoiler).

July, 1918: In the French city of [edited] we met Jane. She was all that my fevered imagination had suggested that a cafe girl ought to be, and she spoke English with an accent novelists speak of as 'charmingly broken', meaning that you couldn't understand her. She also had the English faculty of charging three times what her champagne was worth, so that before we got through we were all charmingly broke.

Like us, Jim and Kay were living through a collective trauma. They were simultaneously witnesses and players. It feels foreign to live through a time that will be imparted to others, endlessly, through books, films and media that doesn't yet exist. We're breathing history that doesn't have a final chapter. Was Jim as burdened by pre-emptive self-awareness as we are now? I doubt it. Because his letters don't speak to historical events and world-changing decisions. They're simply verbal steps, just one foot in front of the other, with little idea of what lies ahead.

Text 3 continues on the next page

Text 3 continued

October 24, 1918: As to narrow escapes — I used to think that I would enjoy telling about one or two that I might have, but I don't. There have been so many of them that they seem commonplace, somehow ... I lost my horse — we used to think that was something to talk about. Well, it isn't. I guess I've seen a dozen of them fall, at different times, within twenty yards of me. I've gone through a swamp full of gas at night — I've taken part in an action on the line ... I did some little of the fighting, and I'm damn sure I did my share of the retreating.

Surprisingly though, it's not descriptions of front-line warfare that make the letters so captivating. It's the humour, the small observations, and the ardent passion of a young man for his sweetheart. I find comfort in this and the lesson it teaches us now.

In the midst of the worst, little things are still important. A smoky room in rural France. The phosphorescence breaking on the bow of a ship. A night's rest under four blankets on a German-built bunk. And throughout it all, love.

August 16, 1918: Oh, Lady, my heart aches to be back with you — and I know that the longer I stay away and the more roughness I run into on my road, the more I'll appreciate you and all that you stand for when I come back.

The activity of transcribing Great-Grandpa's correspondence has been restorative, almost meditative. And it's brought my extended family back into my house. Each time I sit at my desk, a small crowd enters the room. I'll leave the last words to Jim, because he was so good with them. This Anzac Day, he's reminded me to take heart, be brave, and know how much we'll appreciate things when this is all over:

July, 1918: I think — that if I ever get back — this affair will have done me a lot of good. Happiness, as they say, is never appreciated unless it is paid for.

ELLA WARD

Text 4 — Flash Fiction

Snow

I remember the hills in Cleadon in Wales: insignificant, more mounds than hills, but in winter they drew us to them, dragging sledges, smiling, slipping to the top and sliding to the bottom, the thrill of the descent after the sweat of the climb and a lesson in that at least.

The time I remember, it wasn't snowing, but every day for the week before there'd been white on white on white. The covering on the slopes was hard, with a glint to it from the early sun. I was with my brother and there were hardly any others up so early, so we had a free run, he first, me following, and we spent an hour on our favourite part of the hill.

It was his idea to try the steep slope. Two years younger, but always more hardy – always more everything – he said nothing, just smiled, and dragged his sledge up to the trees at the top.

"Here," he said, putting down his sledge. "Me first."

And he was off, headfirst. The sound of it was beautiful, quiet, almost nothing, a hush of speed, diminishing, gone and I watched him, the roll, the crash, his laughter. He picked up the sledge – it was tough, wooden slats, steel runners, and it seemed to have survived – but instead of starting his ascent, he beckoned me, silent, nodding.

Sometimes I think I have never moved from that spot. But I did. I pushed myself forward but as soon as I gathered a little pace I hung my legs over the side of the sledge, dragging my feet against the packed snow. I rolled off a long, long way from the bottom. My sledge hardly made it to the wall and when it did, it came to rest with a bump, nothing more.

My brother carried it to me, handed me the rope. He said nothing, just smiled and we walked back over to the slower slope, the smaller climb, where we stayed for an hour as more friends arrived.

Soon, what had happened on the big slope seemed lost in the chaos of the morning but some things can never be lost; some things don't pass like the seasons but stay, harden, packed down together with other memories, other small failures and always there is a child standing at the top of a slope, frightened, making a choice, deciding to do but not to do with any conviction, and there is a life lived in the wake of that moment which could not have turned out any other way.

JASON JACKSON

End of Stimulus Booklet

English Advanced

Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

General Instructions

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour and 30 minutes
- Write using black pen
- A Stimulus Booklet is provided with this paper
- Write your student number/name at the bottom of this page and at the top of every other page

Total marks: 40

Section I – 20 marks (pages 2–8)

- Attempt Questions 1–5
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 20 marks (pages 9–13)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 6(a)–6(n)
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

This paper MUST NOT be removed from the examination room

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Section I

20 marks

Attempt Questions 1 – 5

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Read the texts on pages 2–6 of the Stimulus Booklet carefully and then answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Your answers will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
- analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts

Question 1 (3 marks)

Text 1 — Prose non-fiction

Explain how **Text 1** evokes the experience of winter in the Illawarra.

3

This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwriting practice. It consists of ten evenly spaced, horizontal dashed lines extending across the entire width of the page. The background is plain white, providing a clear guide for letter height and placement. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Question 2 (5 marks)

Text 2 — Poem

Analyse how Bruce Dawe explores the ways humans make sense of their world.

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Question 2 continues on page 4

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Question 2 (continued)

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Section 1 continues on page 5

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Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences**

Section I (continued)

Attempt Questions 3–5

Answer the questions in the spaces provided. These spaces provide guidance for the expected length of response.

Question 3 (3 marks)

Text 3 — Feature article

How does Ella Ward use a parallel structure to connect her experiences to those of her great grandfather?

3

Question 5 (5 marks)

Text 3 and Text 4 — Feature article and Flash fiction

To what extent is a personal response to an experience explored in *Letters from My Grandfather* and *Snow*? **5**

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Question 5 continues on page 8

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

Question 5 (continued)

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End of Question 5

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Paper 1 — Texts and Human Experiences

Section II

20 marks
Attempt ONE question from Questions 6(a)–6(n)

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on a separate page or writing booklet, if provided.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- * demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - * analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
 - * organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context
-

Question 6 (20 marks)

Prose Fiction

(a) Anthony Doerr, *All the Light We Cannot See*

Write a personal reflection on the insights this novel gave you into Werner's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on Werner's experience with Marie-Laure and ONE other person.

OR

(b) Amanda Lohrey, *Vertigo*

Write a personal reflection on the insights this novella gave you into Anna's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on Anna's experience with Luke and the 'boy'.

OR

Question 6 continues on page 10

Question 6 (continued)

(c) **George Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this novel gave you into Winston's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on Winston's experience with O'Brien and ONE other person.

OR

(d) **Favel Parrett, *Past the Shallows***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this novel gave you into Harry's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on Harry's experience with his Dad and ONE other person.

OR

Poetry

(e) **Rosemary Dobson, *Rosemary Dobson Collected***

Write a personal reflection on the insights Rosemary Dobson's poetry gave you into human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on human experiences represented in TWO of her prescribed poems.

The prescribed poems are:

- * *Young Girl at a Window*
- * *Over the Hill*
- * *Summer's End*
- * *The Conversation*
- * *Cock Crow*
- * *Amy Caroline*
- * *Canberra Morning*

OR

Question 6 continues on page 11

Question 6 (continued)

(f) **Kenneth Slessor, *Selected Poems***

Write a personal reflection on the insights **Kenneth Slessor's** poetry gave you into human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on human experiences represented in TWO of his poems.

The prescribed poems are:

- * *Wild Grapes*
- * *Gulliver*
- * *Out of Time*
- * *Vesper-Song of the Reverend Samuel Marsden*
- * *William Street*
- * *Beach Burial*

OR

Drama

(g) **Jane Harrison, *Rainbow's End*, from Vivienne Cleven et al., *Contemporary Indigenous Plays***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this play gave you into Nan's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on Nan's experience with Gladys and at least ONE other person.

OR

(h) **Arthur Miller, *The Crucible***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this play gave you into John's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on John's experience with Elizabeth and at least ONE other person.

OR

Question 6 continues on page 12

Question 6 (continued)

Shakespearean Drama

- (i) **William Shakespeare, *The Merchant of Venice***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this play gave you into Shylock's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on Shylock's experience with Antonio and Jessica.

OR

Nonfiction

- (j) **Tim Winton, *The Boy Behind the Curtain***

Write a personal reflection on the insights Tim Winton's essays gave you into his human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on his experience with his family.

The prescribed chapters are:

- * *Havoc: A Life in Accidents*
- * *Betsy*
- * *Twice on Sundays*
- * *The Wait and the Flow*
- * *In the Shadow of the Hospital*
- * *The Demon Shark*
- * *Barefoot in the Temple of Art*

OR

- (k) **Malala Yousafzai and Christina Lamb, *I am Malala***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this memoir gave you into Malala's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on Malala's experience with her father and at least ONE other person.

OR

Question 6 continues on page 13

Question 6 (continued)

Film

(l) **Stephen Daldry, *Billy Elliot***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this film gave you into Billy's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on his experience with his father and at least ONE other person.

OR

Media

(m) **Ivan O'Mahoney, *Go Back to Where You Came From***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this television series gave you into Raquel's and Darren's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on their participation in the experiences of refugees or asylum seekers.

The prescribed episodes are:

* *Series 1: Episodes 1, 2 and 3*

and

* *The Response*

OR

(n) **Lucy Walker, *Waste Land***

Write a personal reflection on the insights this documentary gave you into Vik's human qualities and emotions.

Base your reflection on his experience with Tiao and at least ONE of the other *catadores*.

End of paper

STUDENT NUMBER/NAME:

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